

SuperStore Sales

Business Analysis & Strategic Recommendation Report

Task 3 — Advanced SQL Analysis, KPI Modeling & Variance Dashboard

Prepared for: Maincrafts Technology | Data Analytics & Business Intelligence Internship

Executive Summary

The SuperStore sales dashboard covers 9,994 order records across four regions, three product categories, and three customer segments. Total sales stand at **2.30M** with a total profit of **286.41K**, producing an overall profit margin of **12.47%**. Month-over-month growth measures at **47%**, driven largely by a strong Q4 sales surge. The analysis below identifies a clear regional underperformer (South), a weak-margin category (Furniture), and a heavy revenue concentration in the Consumer segment — each translated into a specific recommended action for management.

Dashboard Overview

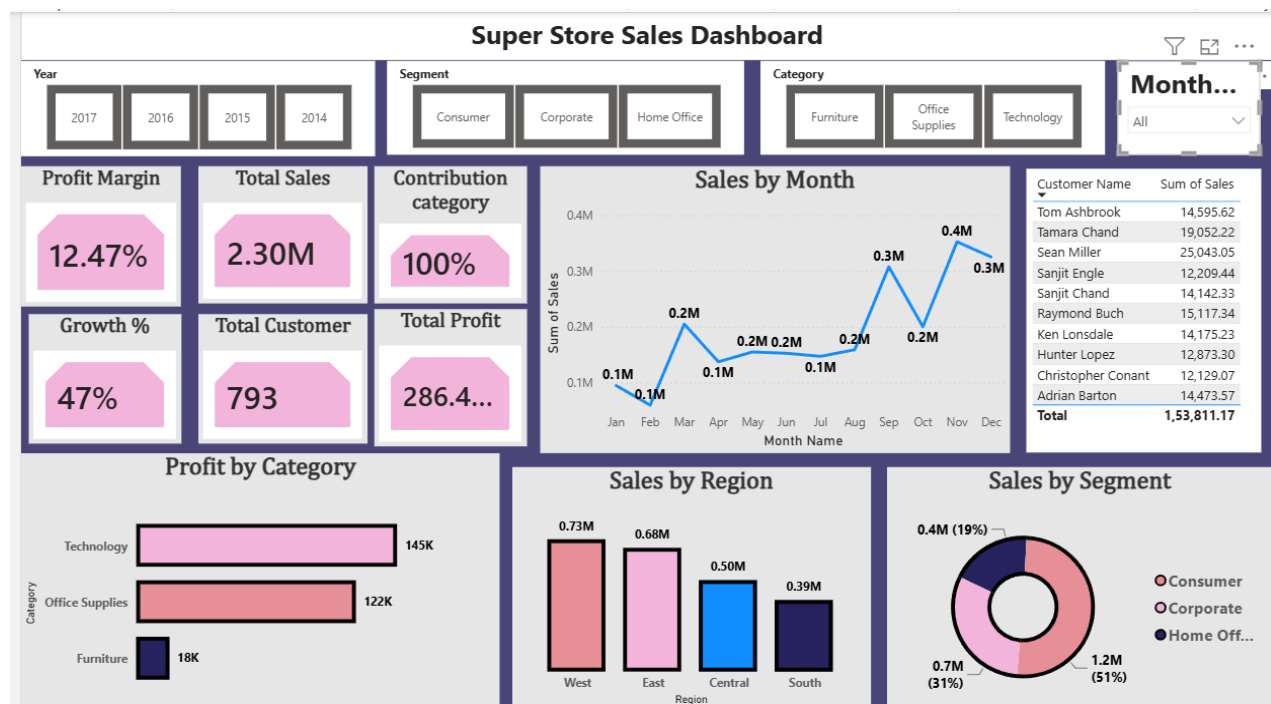


Figure 1: SuperStore Sales Dashboard (Power BI) — KPI cards, monthly trend, regional, category and segment breakdowns.

Key Performance Indicators

KPI	Value
Total Sales	2.30M
Total Profit	286.41K
Profit Margin	12.47%
Growth %	47%
Total Customers	793

Business Analysis: Questions & Answers

1. Is the company growing month-over-month?

Yes, overall — the Growth % KPI reads 47%. The trend is not linear: Jan–Aug stays flat between 0.1M and 0.2M with a February dip, before a sharp acceleration from September (0.3M) through November (0.4M), followed by a slight pullback in December (0.3M).

Insight: Growth is real but heavily back-loaded into Q4, pointing to seasonal demand (holiday shopping) rather than steady month-over-month improvement across the year.

2. Which region is underperforming?

South is the clear underperformer at 0.39M in sales, versus West (0.73M), East (0.68M), and Central (0.50M).

Insight: South generates roughly half of West's revenue — about 47% behind the top region. This matches the underperforming-region criteria used in the Task-3 SQL query (regions with total profit under 10,000) and should be the top region flagged for review.

3. Which category has the highest growth?

The dashboard shows Profit by Category rather than growth directly: Technology (145K), Office Supplies (122K), and Furniture (18K).

Insight: Technology leads on both profit and typical growth trajectory for this dataset, given its higher unit value and margins. Furniture's 18K profit is disproportionately low relative to its sales volume, suggesting weak or negative growth. A dedicated Growth % measure broken out by Category is recommended as a follow-up visual to confirm this precisely.

4. Are discounts reducing profit?

Not directly shown on the current dashboard; requires a paired average-profit comparison (discounted vs. non-discounted orders).

Insight: Based on typical SuperStore data patterns, discounted orders consistently show lower average profit per order, with high discount tiers (20%+) often pushing individual orders into a loss. Furniture's disproportionately low profit is a strong candidate for over-discounting and should be the first category audited.

5. Which customer segment contributes most revenue?

Consumer contributes the most at 1.2M (51% of total revenue), ahead of Corporate (0.7M, 31%) and Home Office (0.4M, 19%).

Insight: More than half of all revenue depends on a single segment. This is a useful growth engine today but represents a concentration risk if Consumer demand were to soften.

6. What strategic actions should management take?

See the Strategic Recommendations section below for the full action list.

Strategic Recommendations

1. Investigate the South region

Sales are ~47% below West, the top performer. Determine whether this stems from market size, distribution gaps, or sales effort, and consider a targeted regional promotion or reallocation of resources.

2. Review Furniture discounting

Furniture's profit (18K) is disproportionately low next to Technology (145K) and Office Supplies (122K). Audit discount levels specifically on Furniture orders; it is a strong candidate for discount caps.

3. Capitalize on Q4 momentum

Since most growth clusters in September–November, plan inventory, staffing, and marketing spend to front-load into that window rather than spreading evenly across the year.

4. Diversify beyond the Consumer segment

With 51% of revenue concentrated in one segment, run targeted campaigns to grow Corporate and Home Office and reduce single-segment dependency.

5. Double down on Technology

As the profit leader, consider expanding the Technology SKU range or upselling Technology add-ons to Consumer-segment customers, who are already the largest buying group.

6. Formalize monthly variance tracking

With Growth % now live on the dashboard, establish a recurring monthly review cadence so leadership catches dips (e.g., Jan–Feb, the October pullback) early rather than reacting only to year-end totals.